

Questions for ADP

ADP leads the field by *\$4,586 a year* and its 401(k) is now fully documented. These five are the things that could still change that — the renewal date, and three costs we have taken on trust.

YEAR 1 AS MODELED	SERVICE FEE	CONTRIBUTION FLOOR	PLANS AVAILABLE	RENEWAL
\$46,981	1.53% · \$10,072	\$187.02	11 Aetna rungs	6 / 01 / 2027

WHY THESE FIVE

ADP wins year one on every line. It loses the **two-year** comparison — \$119,331 against TriNet's \$116,525 — for one reason: its plan year ends 6/1/2027, so Onyx gets an eight-month first year and absorbs **two increases inside 24 months** where every other vendor absorbs one. Separately, three of ADP's cost lines rest on our reading rather than on their confirmation: **workers' compensation at \$0**, what the **1.53%** is actually charged on, and whether we may keep the cheapest plan on the menu to hold the **\$187.02 floor**.

Ask these five

RANKED BY WHAT THEY CAN MOVE

- 1

Is the June 1 renewal fixed, or can we get a 10/1 anniversary — or rates held through 9/30/2027?

Every plan card in your deck reads "Renewal Info 6/1/2027 — 10%." That gives us an eight-month first plan year and makes ADP the only vendor taking two increases in 24 months. TriNet holds 10/1 in perpetuity; Insperity renews on the anniversary. You are the outlier, and it is the one thing that costs you the two-year comparison.

\$2,806

OVER 24 MONTHS
- 2

Is workers' compensation genuinely inside the 1.53% — no separate premium, no deposit, no year-end audit? And what is the EPLI limit?

We have modeled your workers' comp at \$0 on that basis. It is the single largest assumption running in your favor. TriNet charges \$300 separately and Insperity roughly \$994. Your EPLI is stated as included with no limit given; TriNet states \$1,000,000.

\$0 assumed

LARGEST UNVERIFIED LINE
- 3

What exactly is the 1.53% charged on, and is the rate locked?

It produces \$10,072 on our \$658,322 of gross payroll. Is the base gross wages only, or does it pick up bonuses, owner distributions and employer benefit contributions? Is there a per-employee cap? Is 1.53% guaranteed, and for how long? Yours is the only fee that rises automatically with every raise — it passes TriNet's \$14,400 floor once payroll reaches about \$941,000.

\$10,072

LARGEST REQUIRED LINE

4 Confirm in writing that we choose the lineup — and that we may keep the 8000 ValueINT on it purely to hold the floor.

\$187.02

LOWEST FLOOR IN THE
FIELD

Our \$187.02 floor is 50% of that plan's \$374.03 employee-only rate, and it is the lowest floor of any vendor. Nobody should actually elect it: \$8,000 deductible, \$10,000 out-of-pocket maximum, not HSA-eligible. So confirm two things — there is **no minimum enrollment per plan**, and the floor keys to the cheapest plan **we offer** rather than the cheapest you have. While we are there, confirm the plan list: your deck shows twelve columns but lists the OA EPO HDHP 3500-80% twice, so we count eleven.

5 Do you allow different funding tiers by class, and can we set a zero waiting period for new hires?

TriNet: yes

YOU: UNKNOWN

TriNet has confirmed both. Funding tiers would let Onyx cover Steven's family premium at 100% while holding everyone else at the fixed dollars. A zero waiting period is what puts Jessica on coverage 10/1 rather than later.

Three quick confirms, by email is fine. Whether an adopting employer in your multiple employer plan still claims the **SECURE 2.0 start-up credits** — neither you nor TriNet addresses it · the **Summary Plan Description** and **Investment Policy Statement** for the 401(k), the latter being where 3(38) investment-fiduciary status would appear if it exists · whether **Workforce Now Learning** is inside the 1.53% or an add-on.

- What is already settled with ADP

DO NOT SPEND MEETING TIME HERE

✓ Basic life and long-term disability are elective.

settled

Confirmed on our call. Keeping both costs \$209/yr and our benefit design includes them.

✓ Dental and vision can be employee-paid in full.

settled

Stated outright — "can be employee all paid." Funding them voluntarily would cost \$1,320/yr.

✓ The 401(k) costs Onyx nothing and charges participants no account fee.

settled

Their DOL §404a-5 disclosure dated 6/30/2026 shows administration funded by a 0.22% credit inside fund expenses, recordkeeping at \$49 per participant paid by the plan, and a target-date series at 0.48% all-in. Voya as recordkeeper, ADP as plan sponsor and 3(16) administrator.

✓ Handbook and policy review are included.

settled

ADP confirmed. Onyx already has a handbook, so the value is in maintenance rather than creation.

Before you leave the room

1. **The renewal date is the ask that matters.** Everything else on this page protects a number we already have; question 1 is the only one that can improve ADP's position. A 10/1 anniversary would make ADP the best vendor over two years as well as one.
2. **Get the workers' comp answer in the service agreement, not verbally.** "Inside the fee" is doing a lot of work in our model.
3. **Do not compare their figures for our current costs.** Those numbers were invented, at every vendor. Keep the conversation on their own pricing.

Sources: ADP TotalSource proposal deck pp.6–8, renewal info dated 6/1/2027 · ADP TotalSource financial analysis 8/27/2026 · ADP TotalSource Retirement Savings Plan participant fee disclosure, 6/30/2026 · ADP confirmations on our call
Every dollar figure was re-rated to Onyx's actual enrollment – Lisa employee-only, Christine employee + spouse, Steven and Jessica family, Josephine waiving. ADP quoted \$628,680 of payroll against our actual \$658,322.